Week 45

November 2, 2026

Expana

Global Weekly Industrial and Macroeconomic Insight

METALS	EXPANA SERIES	CURRENT	PREVIOUS	WOW	WOW%
Copper 3m LME	LN06	$14,250/MT	$14,270/MT	-$20	-0.1%
ENERGY		**CURRENT**	**PREVIOUS**	**WOW**	**WOW%**
Crude oil Brent ICE EU (DH-0)	BCRD	$117.64/barrel	$116.72/barrel	+$0.92	+0.8%
Natural gas TTF NL (DH-0)	NGNL	€103.81/MWH	€93.80/MWH	+€10.01	+10.7%
Natural gas NYMEX US (DH-0)	NGAS	$2.90/10Therm	$2.64/10Therm	+$0.26	+9.8%
Electricity base year EEX DE (DH-0)	ED50	€164.27/MWH	€154.42/MWH	+€9.85	+6.4%
CURRENCY		**CURRENT**	**PREVIOUS**	**WOW**	**WOW%**
USD Index	N/A	102.12	101.79	+0.33	+0.32%

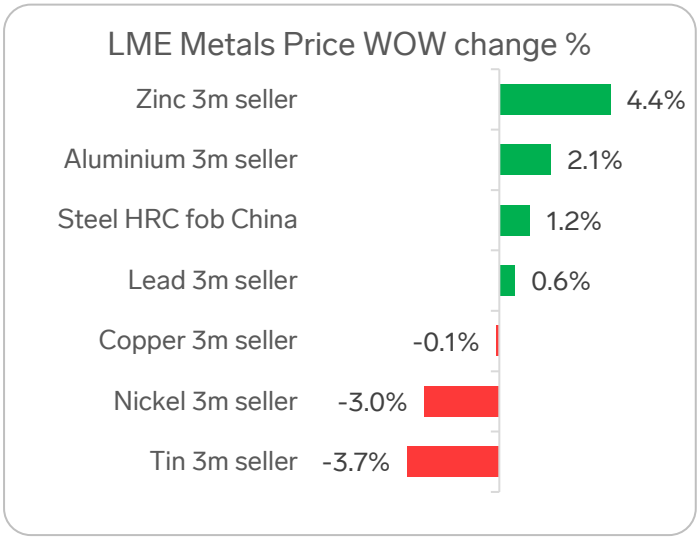
Current daily prices as of October 30, 2026. Previous daily prices as of October 23, 2026.

Key Points

- During the last week of October, base metals prices moved in different directions, driven by fundamental factors.
- Easing demand drove a decrease in the global container index.
- Energy prices rose throughout the week, supported by continued supply disruption in the Strait of Hormuz.

Metals

Base metals prices remained volatile during the last week of October 2026, with different trends across the markets. Zinc recorded the strongest price growth, supported by tightening supply despite seasonally weaker demand. Zinc concentrate availability remains limited, particularly in China, where imports declined in August 2026, increasing pressure on smelters. Aluminum prices also increased, supported by stronger market activity and declining inventories. Meanwhile, nickel prices continued to fall as growing nickel ore shipments from the Philippines to Indonesia helped ease the raw material shortage that had developed earlier in 2026. Tin prices extended their decline despite relatively strong demand and limited raw material availability. Market sources suggest that speculative trading contributed to the decline, as market fundamentals remain relatively tight. Refined tin production was also constrained in October 2026 as one of the largest producers in China, suspended operations for maintenance. Steel markets largely maintained their previous trends. Hot rolled coil (HRC) prices in the EU and US continued to rise, although the rate of monthly price growth slowed in October 2026 compared with September 2026. In China, export HRC prices showed only minor changes during the final week of October, while steel demand remained weak. At the same time, relatively low iron ore and coke prices continued to limit production costs for Chinese steelmakers. Against this background, market sources don't see support for the increase in Chinese HRC export prices in the near term.



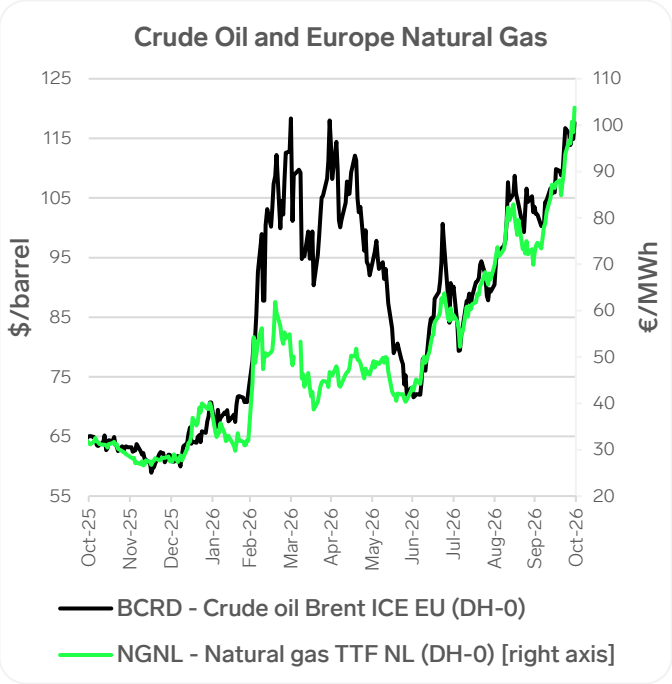
Source: LME

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Energy

Brent crude prices increased 0.8% WOW, to $117.64 per barrel on October 30. Disruption within the Strait of Hormuz continues to add upward momentum to crude oil prices. During the week, sources reported a tanker being hit by limpet mines in the Strait of Hormuz. According to players, the frequency of attacks on tankers remains high, while participants reported no diplomatic progress between the US and Iran. As a result, players in the market remain very concerned about supply.

European natural gas TTF prices rose 10.7% WOW, reaching €103.81/MWh on October 30. Supply remains tight due to lost imports from the Middle East. Players continue to cite the lower YOY storage levels on the continent as further evidence of low supply. Sources also anticipate increased demand with the coming of colder weather during winter.



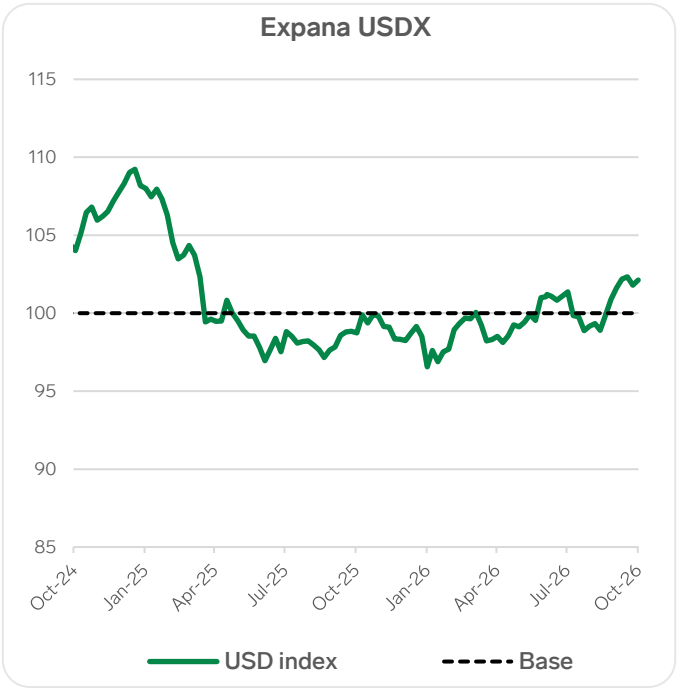
Source: ICE, EEX

Shipping

The Global Shipping 40-foot Container Composite Index decreased by 3% WOW at the end of October to $4,429/unit. Transpacific rates recorded a notable decrease, with Shanghai-LA down by 6% and Shanghai-New York down by 5%. Although prices remain elevated and well above Asia-Europe rates, the moves mark the largest downward shifts on these routes, in WOW terms, since the start of the year. Market sources suggest that US demand is softening, after remaining high since mid-year. Asia-Europe rates showed little WOW change, with Asia-Rotterdam up 1% and Asia-Genoa stable. Although congestion is easing at Far East ports, the possibility of further typhoon events is a watch-out factor. Carriers have announced possible rate increases in November, but sources have expressed skepticism as to whether or not these will take hold, given the easing demand as well as available capacity. With an ongoing resumption of transit through the Red Sea, sources note that the disruption to scheduling, with vessels arriving earlier than intended, could be contributing to port congestion.

Macroeconomics

USDX



Source: XE, Expana

Expana's US Dollar Index (USDX) was 102.12, up 0.32% WOW. Middle East conflict-related safe-haven demand continued to add upward pressure to the USDX. Furthermore, inflation continues to accelerate due to elevated energy prices. As a result of the inflation acceleration, players anticipate another 25 basis point interest rate hike in December by the US Federal Reserve, a sentiment that is supporting the USDX.